



CliftonStrengths® Top 5 for James Cook

This report presents your five most dominant CliftonStrengths revealed by your responses to the CliftonStrengths assessment. Use this report to learn more about these strengths, how they uniquely show up in your life and how you can use them to fulfil your potential.

1. Context®

■ STRATEGIC THINKING

You enjoy thinking about the past. You understand the present by researching its history.

2. Activator®

■ INFLUENCING

You can make things happen by turning thoughts into action. You want to do things now, rather than simply talk about them.

3. Input®

■ STRATEGIC THINKING

You have a need to collect and archive. You may accumulate information, ideas, artefacts or even relationships.

4. Command®

■ INFLUENCING

You have presence. You can take control of a situation and make decisions.

5. Achiever®

■ EXECUTING

You work hard and possess a great deal of stamina. You take immense satisfaction in being busy and productive.



STRATEGIC THINKING

1. Context®

What Is Context?

Perspective and background are important for people with strong Context talents. They value the retrospective viewpoint because they believe that is where the answers lie. They look back to understand the present. From the past, they can discern blueprints for the future. People with dominant Context talents might feel disorientated when they can't see patterns stemming from prior events. Others may become impatient with them as they strive to understand the history of a given situation. But this historical context gives them confidence in their decisions.

Chances are good that you sometimes seek the company of historically minded people. Perhaps you ask what they think about past events or specific luminaries — that is, prominent individuals.

Because of your strengths, you are quite intrigued by history's significant events and people. Information about global conflicts fascinates you.

Instinctively, you are devoted to studying the past. This is one way you make sense of the present. It probably explains why you can predict how people will behave, how problems will be solved, how decisions will be made or how events will unfold.

Driven by your talents, you set aside time to examine past events as well as the lives of historic figures. You probably construct timelines when you need a framework within which to sort through historic evidence. You likely research topics quite thoroughly before you draw any conclusions.

By nature, you occasionally savor the time you spend with people who are knowledgeable about events of the past. Maybe they enlighten you about important events, places, or individuals. Perhaps bits of this information cause you to reflect on what could have been improved or done better.



INFLUENCING

2. Activator®

What Is Activator?

'When can we start?' This is a recurring question for Activators. People with strong Activator talents are impatient for action. They may concede that analysis has its uses or that debate and discussion can occasionally yield some valuable insights, but deep down they know that only action is real. Once a decision is made, they must act. Others may worry that 'there are still some things we don't know', but this doesn't seem to slow Activators down. They make a decision, take action, look at the result and learn. The bottom line is this: Activators know they will be judged not by what they say or what they think, but by what they get done. This does not frighten them. It energises them.

By nature, you may help people know you better as a person when you openly share what you think, feel, have done, are doing, or hope to accomplish. To some extent, you are eager to tell your story. Why? When others know more about you, perhaps the relationship helps you more easily convince them to get busy working on a particular project, assignment, or chore.

Chances are good that you traditionally determine for yourself and others what should be done. After you have made up your mind, you typically waste little time moving forward with projects or assignments.

It's very likely that you sometimes gravitate to situations where you can be your true self. You might feel life is wonderful when people listen as you share stories about your successes, failures, talents, limitations, hope, or fears.

Because of your strengths, you may influence some of your friends to make things happen quickly. Sometimes you create enthusiasm in others by championing a particular project, rule, process, activity, or idea.

Instinctively, you sometimes influence people to produce results, sign up to work on projects, or rally around causes. When you take time to know them as individuals, people may be more willing to move into action at your prompting. Perhaps they realize you appreciate some of their talents, interests, or experiences.



STRATEGIC THINKING

3. Input®

What Is Input?

People with strong Input talents are inquisitive and always want to know more. They crave information. They might collect ideas, books, memorabilia, quotations or facts. Whatever they collect, they do so because it interests them. They find many things interesting and have a natural curiosity. The world is exciting precisely because of its infinite variety and complexity. A few minutes spent surfing the internet may turn into hours once their curiosity takes off. They constantly acquire, compile and file things away. Their pursuits keep their minds fresh. They know that one day the information or things they've gathered will prove valuable.

Chances are good that you usually equate education — formal and informal — with understanding more about something today than you understood about it yesterday.

It's very likely that you put yourself in the middle of mentally stimulating conversations. You want to gather new ideas, discover new approaches, hear about new theories, consider new concepts, or apply new technologies. Often you are one of the early discoverers of innovations. Others can lag behind if they wish, but you consistently acquire knowledge. You exhibit little need to know precisely where all this information ultimately will lead you.

Instinctively, you are more comfortable talking about ideas than issuing orders or dealing with conflict. You gravitate to conversations with intelligent people. You intentionally cast aside emotions and concentrate on the facts. You continually search for evidence to make your points and wish others would do the same.

By nature, you pay close attention to current events. Numerous people merely recount what they heard, saw, or read. Typically you dive deeper into the topic. You are likely to generate theories, concepts, or philosophies to explain the reasoning behind newsmakers' decisions. You routinely gather information about events, policy statements, people, or crises. Your fresh insights are likely to draw equally engaged thinkers into the conversation.



INFLUENCING

4. Command®

What Is Command?

People with strong Command talents naturally take charge. They see what needs to be done and are willing to speak up. Confrontation does not frighten them; rather, they understand that it is the first step towards resolution. They need things to be clear among people, and they will challenge others to be realistic and honest. Their talent pushes them to take risks. At times, those with strong Command talents may intimidate others. And while some may resent this talent, others often willingly hand them the reins. People are drawn towards those who take a stand and are willing to lead.

By nature, you occasionally emphasize facts or point others in the direction of truth. You may wake up those who are deluded — that is, easily misled, deceived, or tricked. Perhaps your honest, direct, and plainspoken approach cuts through individuals' delusions so they can begin seeing specific things clearly. Maybe your matter-of-fact style helps a few people identify common ground. Now and then, consensus — that is, complete agreement — might occur.

It's very likely that you are an original and innovative thinker. Others frequently rely on you to generate novel concepts, theories, plans, or solutions. You refuse to be stifled by traditions or trapped by routines. You probably bristle when someone says, "We can't change that. We've always done it this way."

Because of your strengths, you may approach certain win-lose situations in a practical and realistic manner. When you are intent on being victorious, perhaps you extinguish any sentimental feelings you might have toward your rivals.

Chances are good that you influence people into seeing things differently. You often influence their actions. You can tell individuals or groups they must think beyond current rules, traditions, or practices.

Instinctively, you contribute many innovative ideas to the group during brainstorming sessions. You tend to be highly imaginative when proposals are fully heard and any criticism is reserved for a later time.



EXECUTING

5. Achiever®

What Is Achiever?

Achievers have a constant need for attainment. They have an internal fire burning inside them. It pushes them to do and achieve more. People with strong Achiever talents feel as if every day starts at zero. By the end of the day, they must accomplish something meaningful to feel good about themselves. And 'every day' means every single day: workdays, weekends, public holidays and even holidays. If the day passes without some form of achievement, no matter how small, Achievers feel dissatisfied. After finishing a challenging project, they rarely seek a reward of a rest or an easy assignment. While they appreciate recognition for past achievements, their motivation lies in striving towards the next goal on the horizon.

It's very likely that you frequently engage in laborious tasks. You yearn to dedicate yourself to worthy causes or noble purposes. Fortifying the bonds between yourself, the people you know, or even those you will never meet gives your life special meaning.

Because of your strengths, you exhibit a strong work ethic. Work probably gives your life a sense of purpose it would otherwise lack.

Driven by your talents, you are hardwired to work industriously. You willingly devote hours and energy to your job or studies. When you know your scores, ratings, rankings, or performance might be compared to the results of others, you might redouble your efforts to be the best.

Instinctively, you decide for yourself what course of action to take. You work in earnest to see clear distinctions between right and wrong. You choose to ignore what others might think or say about your core values or code of ethics.

Chances are good that you do much more than just try to live up to your commitments. You persist working until you can deliver on your promises. This certainly enhances your reputation for being trustworthy, reliable, and dependable.